LST-P2 · PRÁCTICA 03

Sentence completion

Hoja 03 · Términos, homófonos y condiciones gramaticales · dificultad 3 de 4

9 preguntas (7–15) · 1 punto por pregunta · audio: LST-P2_Practica_03.mp3 · el monólogo suena dos veces, con las pausas del examen · sin consultar la teoría

You will hear an acoustic engineer called Mark Treloar talking about how concert halls are designed. For questions 7–15, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

Designing a concert hall

The speaker uses the technical term ___7___ for the way sound continues after the music stops.

Because listeners need to follow the words, ___8___ requires sound to fade more quickly than orchestral music does.

Halls that are long, narrow and tall are nicknamed ___9___.

Fan-shaped halls caught on because they could accommodate more ___10___.

Thin wooden panels are a problem because they soak up the ___11___.

The one material the speaker would rather not have in a hall at all is ___12___.

An unoccupied seat should absorb as much sound as an ___13___.

The speaker believes electronic systems can make a ___14___ hall far more versatile.

In the speaker's view, nothing can substitute for musicians' ___15___ of a particular hall.

Hoja de respuestas

Escribe las palabras que oyes, sin cambiarlas, y comprueba que encajan en la frase y que están bien escritas. 1 punto por respuesta correcta. En el examen en papel: mayúsculas, una letra por casilla.

Nº	Respuesta	Puntos
7		/ 1
8		/ 1
9		/ 1
10		/ 1
11		/ 1
12		/ 1
13		/ 1
14		/ 1
15		/ 1
	Total	**/ 9**

SOLUCIONES

1 punto por respuesta correcta y bien escrita. La clave sigue la convención de Cambridge: las palabras entre paréntesis son opcionales y la barra separa alternativas. Debajo de cada respuesta van las que no valen: candidatos que se oyen pero no cumplen la condición de la frase (§6.3), formas que no encajan o palabras que no se oyen (§6.4) y errores de ortografía (§6.5). Los números de sección remiten a LST_Teoria_v1.

Clave rápida

Nº	Clave	No vale	Teoría
7	**reverberation**	echo · reverbaration	§6.4 · §6.5
8	**opera**	church music · choir	§6.3 · §6.2
9	**shoeboxes / shoe boxes**	shoebox · fan-shaped halls	§6.4 · §6.3
10	**seats**	musicians · people	§6.3 · §3.2
11	**bass**	base · high frequencies	§6.5 · §6.3
12	**glass**	wood · concrete	§6.3
13	**adult (in a winter coat)**	child · seated person	§6.2 · §6.3
14	**(decent) multi-purpose / (decent) multipurpose**	bad · decent	§6.4 · §6.3
15	**experience**	ear · knowledge	§6.3 · §2.3

Transcripción

Voz · William, inglés australiano

Thanks very much for having me. I've spent most of my career designing concert halls, and the first thing I usually have to do is correct a misunderstanding. People assume the aim is to make the music louder. It isn't. That's not to say loudness is irrelevant, but it's rarely the problem. What matters most is how long the sound lingers in the air once the musicians have stopped – **what we call reverberation** [7]. Too little of it, and an orchestra sounds dry and thin, as if it were playing in a carpeted living room. Too much, and every note smears into the next, which is what tends to happen in cathedrals.

For a symphony orchestra, the ideal is around two seconds. **Opera needs rather less** [8], because the audience has to follow the words, whereas a choir singing church music can cope with a great deal more. Getting that figure right is most of the job. It's also why a hall designed for one purpose rarely works perfectly for another, and why so many of the halls built in the nineteen-sixties, which tried to cater for everything from rock concerts to conferences, ended up doing nothing particularly well.

The shape of the room matters enormously. The halls musicians love most are often the old rectangular ones – long, narrow and high, **which is why we call them shoe boxes** [9]. Their side walls are close enough to bounce sound back across the audience from both directions, and our brains find that deeply satisfying. Fan-shaped halls, which became popular because **you could fit more seats in** [10] – not, as people sometimes claim, more musicians on the stage – tend to lose that effect, because the walls angle away from the listener.

> Materials are the next big decision. Wood has a wonderful reputation, and clients nearly always ask for it, but thin wooden panels actually **absorb the bass** [11], which is the opposite of what you want. In most of our halls, what you see is a thin layer of timber for the look of the thing, fixed to heavy plaster or concrete, which does the real acoustic work. The one material I try to **keep out of a hall altogether is glass** [12], simply because it reflects high frequencies far too harshly.
>
> Then there's the audience. People are surprisingly good at absorbing sound, so a full hall can sound completely different from an empty one, which makes rehearsals a nightmare. Our solution is to design the seats so that an empty one absorbs roughly as much sound as a seated person – not a child, mind you, but **an adult in a winter coat** [13]. We test this, incidentally, with volunteers, and the coats are part of the test. So if you've ever wondered why concert seats have such thick, padded backs, the answer isn't comfort. It's acoustics.
>
> Finally, a word about the newest trend, which is electronic enhancement: hidden microphones and speakers that can change a hall's reverberation at the press of a button. Some of my colleagues think it's cheating. I'm not so sure. It won't turn a bad hall into a great one, but it can make **a decent multi-purpose hall** [14] genuinely flexible, which is more than architecture alone has ever managed. What no technology I know of can replace is not the instruments, or even the conductor's ear. **It's the experience of the musicians** [15] themselves, who learn a hall over years, the way you get to know a person.

Explicaciones

7 • reverberation

Frase: The speaker uses the technical term **reverberation** for the way sound continues after the music stops.

Se oye: what we call reverberation

Se acepta: reverberation

Define el término y lo nombra: how long the sound lingers in the air once the musicians have stopped – what we call reverberation. La frase del papel pide el nombre técnico, así que no vale una descripción.

No vale echo (sinónimo §6.4). No es la palabra que se oye.

No vale reverbaration (ortografía §6.5). Es rever-ber-ation, como el verbo reverberate.

Teoría: §6.4 Qué se escribe · §6.5 Ortografía

8 • opera

Frase: Because listeners need to follow the words, **opera** requires sound to fade more quickly than orchestral music does.

Se oye: Opera needs rather less

Se acepta: opera

Se comparan tres tipos de música; solo uno necesita menos y por las palabras: Opera needs rather less, because the audience has to follow the words.

No vale church music (candidato §6.3). También tiene letra, pero tolera mucha más reverberación: can cope with a great deal more.

No vale choir (candidato §6.3). Es el mismo caso que church music.

Teoría: §6.3 Varios candidatos para un mismo hueco · §6.2 Los 45 segundos: predecir cada hueco

9 • shoeboxes / shoe boxes

Frase: Halls that are long, narrow and tall are nicknamed **shoeboxes**.

Se oye: which is why we call them shoe boxes

Se acepta: shoeboxes · shoe boxes

Describe la forma y le da nombre: long, narrow and high, which is why we call them shoe boxes. Se aceptan las dos grafías del compuesto; el sujeto plural (Halls) pide el plural.

No vale shoebox (forma §6.4). Se oye en plural y el sujeto es plural.

No vale fan-shaped halls (candidato §6.3). Es la otra forma de sala, con las paredes abiertas, no largas y estrechas.

Teoría: §6.4 Qué se escribe · §6.3 Varios candidatos para un mismo hueco

10 • seats

Frase: Fan-shaped halls caught on because they could accommodate more **seats**.

Se oye: you could fit more seats in

Se acepta: seats

Se da la razón y se descarta la versión popular: you could fit more seats in – not, as people sometimes claim, more musicians on the stage.

No vale musicians (candidato §6.3). Lo que se dice a veces, y el hablante lo descarta (not, as people sometimes claim).

No vale people (sinónimo §6.4). No es lo que se oye.

Teoría: §6.3 Varios candidatos para un mismo hueco · §3.2 Voz propia y voces ajenas

11 • bass

Frase: Thin wooden panels are a problem because they soak up the **bass**.

Se oye: absorb the bass

Se acepta: bass

La madera tiene un inconveniente: thin wooden panels actually absorb the bass, which is the opposite of what you want. En el papel, soak up reformula absorb.

No vale base (ortografía §6.5). Homófono: base es la base; los graves son bass.

No vale high frequencies (candidato §6.3). Es lo que refleja el vidrio, no lo que absorbe la madera.

Teoría: §6.5 Ortografía · §6.3 Varios candidatos para un mismo hueco

12 • glass

Frase: The one material the speaker would rather not have in a hall at all is **glass**.

Se oye: keep out of a hall altogether is glass

Se acepta: glass

De los cuatro materiales que menciona, solo uno queda fuera del todo: The one material I try to keep out of a hall altogether is glass.

No vale wood (candidato §6.3). Tiene inconvenientes, pero lo usa como capa visible (a thin layer of timber).

No vale concrete (candidato §6.3). Al contrario: does the real acoustic work.

Teoría: §6.3 Varios candidatos para un mismo hueco

13 • adult (in a winter coat)

Frase: An unoccupied seat should absorb as much sound as an **adult in a winter coat**.

Se oye: an adult in a winter coat

Se acepta: adult in a winter coat · adult

El hablante precisa su propia frase: a seated person – not a child, mind you, but an adult in a winter coat. El an del papel ya exige una palabra que empiece por vocal.

No vale child (candidato §6.3). Descartado: not a child.

No vale seated person (forma §6.4). No encaja tras an y además el hablante lo precisa a continuación.

Teoría: §6.2 Los 45 segundos: predecir cada hueco · §6.3 Varios candidatos para un mismo hueco

14 • (decent) multi-purpose / (decent) multipurpose

Frase: The speaker believes electronic systems can make a **decent multi-purpose** hall far more versatile.

Se oye: a decent multi-purpose hall

Se acepta: decent multi-purpose · multi-purpose · decent multipurpose · multipurpose

It won't turn a bad hall into a great one, but it can make a decent multi-purpose hall genuinely flexible. Se aceptan las dos grafías, con o sin decent.

No vale bad (candidato §6.3). Lo que la tecnología no puede arreglar (It won't turn a bad hall into a great one).

No vale decent (incompleta §6.4). Sin multi-purpose se pierde lo que importa: la sala polivalente.

Teoría: §6.4 Qué se escribe · §6.3 Varios candidatos para un mismo hueco

15 • experience

Frase: In the speaker's view, nothing can substitute for musicians' **experience** of a particular hall.

Se oye: It's the experience of the musicians

Se acepta: experience

Dos negaciones antes de la respuesta: is not the instruments, or even the conductor's ear. It's the experience of the musicians themselves.

No vale ear (candidato §6.3). Descartado: or even the conductor's ear.

No vale knowledge (sinónimo §6.4). No es lo que se oye.

Teoría: §6.3 Varios candidatos para un mismo hueco · §2.3 Señales del discurso oral